COMMUNITY VOIE VÉRITÉ VIE (3V)

NOVENA

SAINT JOSEPH

Nine days of prayer, meditation and intercession

walking with the silent Guardian of the Saviour

« Go to Joseph. Do whatever he tells you. »

— cf. Genesis 41:55

Community Voie Vérité Vie (3V)

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

INTRODUCTION

Daily schedule of the novena 3

Common prayers for opening and closing 4

Introduction prayer to the novena 6

THE NINE DAYS

Day I — Joseph, a Just Man 7

Day II — Joseph, Spouse of Mary 8

Day III — Joseph, Father of Jesus 9

Day IV — Joseph, Man of Silence 10

Day V — Joseph, Craftsman of Nazareth 11

Day VI — Joseph's Flight into Egypt 12

Day VII — Joseph, Patron of Families 13

Day VIII — Joseph, Patron of the Dying 14

Day IX — Joseph, Patron of the Universal Church 15

CONCLUSION

Act of consecration to Saint Joseph 17

Litany of Saint Joseph 18

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DAILY SCHEDULE

Structure to follow each day of the novena

OPENING

①	✝ **Sign of the Cross**
②	■ **Prayer to the Holy Spirit**
③	■ **Our Father**

BODY — PRAYER OF THE DAY

④	■ **Word of God** *Verse of the day's theme*
⑤	■ **Meditation** *Three points of contemplation*
⑥	■ **Intercession prayers** *Four thematic intentions*
⑦	✍ **My personal intention** *Free prayer space*
⑧	❄ **Time of silence** *Laying one's heart before God*

CLOSING

⑨	■ **Hail Mary**
⑩	■ **Hail Joseph**
■	■ **Glory Be**
■	■ **Hymn to the Holy Spirit** *According to your community's tradition*
■	✝ **Sign of the Cross**

❄ This schedule is identical every day · Only the BODY content varies ❄

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COMMON PRAYERS

Recited at the opening and closing of each day

OPENING

† Sign of the Cross

In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

■ Prayer to the Holy Spirit

Come, Holy Spirit, fill the hearts of your faithful
and kindle in them the fire of your love.
V. Send forth your Spirit, O Lord, and they shall be created.
R. And you shall renew the face of the earth.
Holy Spirit, soul of my soul, I adore you.
You who are the light of minds, enlighten my spirit.
You who are the strength of weak souls, fortify my will.
You who are the consolation of afflicted hearts, console my heart.
You who are the wisdom of the humble, guide my steps.
You who are the source of all holiness, purify my life.
Enlighten me, guide me, strengthen me, console me.
Tell me what I ought to do and command me to do it.
I promise to be submissive to everything you desire of me
and to accept everything you permit to happen to me.
Only make known to me your will.
Spirit of truth, drive from me all illusion, all pride and all falsehood.
Spirit of love, uproot from my heart all bitterness, all resentment and all selfishness.
Spirit of peace, calm in me all that still resists God.
Spirit of strength, sustain me in the battles of faith and in the faithfulness of each day.
Come into me, Holy Spirit. Not for a moment, but to dwell.
Not as a visitor, but as master of my life.
Take all that I am, all that I have, all that I do,
and make of it an offering pleasing to the Father,
through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

■ Our Father

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name;
thy kingdom come, thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
and forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us;
and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. Amen.

CLOSING

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■ Hail Mary

Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee;
blessed art thou among women,
and blessed is the fruit of thy womb, Jesus.
Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners,
now and at the hour of our death. Amen.

■ Hail Joseph

Hail, Joseph, son of David, spouse of the Virgin Mary and foster father of Jesus.
Faithful guardian of the mysteries of God,
you who held in your arms the Saviour of the world,
obtain for us the grace to walk in justice, faith and love.
O Joseph, model of pure hearts and silent souls,
intercede for us before Jesus your Son,
he who refuses nothing to the one he called father on earth.
Saint Joseph, pray for us. Amen.

■ Glory Be

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit,
as it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

❈ « Go to Joseph. Do whatever he tells you. » ❈

— cf. Genesis 41:55

■ Hymn to the Holy Spirit

E.g.: Come Holy Spirit · Breath of God · Spirit of the Living God
(Or any other invocation hymn to the Holy Spirit according to your liturgical tradition.)

† Sign of the Cross

In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

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INTRODUCTION PRAYER TO THE NOVENA

O Saint Joseph, foster father of the Son of God, most chaste spouse of the Virgin Mary, silent guardian of the mysteries of salvation, it is to you that we turn at the beginning of this novena, with humble faith and filial trust.

You have never refused anyone who turned to you with a sincere heart. You carried in your arms the Saviour of the world, watched over him in his weakness as a child, worked for him in the obscurity of Nazareth, protected his Mother with tenderness and courage. You did everything in silence, never seeking glory or recognition.

We come to you today with our needs, our wounds, our hopes and our doubts. We come to you with this intention that weighs on our heart and which we place now in your hands. You know it better than we could ever formulate. Present it to Jesus, your beloved Son, who refuses you nothing.

During these nine days, walk with us. Teach us to pray as you prayed, to listen as you listened, to obey as you obeyed. Form in us that just and upright heart that God loved so much in you. And at the end of this novena, may we be able to say with faith: Lord, your will has been done — and it is good.

Saint Joseph, we are your children. Intercede for us. Amen.

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DAY I · JOSEPH, A JUST MAN

Holiness in ordinary daily life

[Opening: ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 4) · ■ Prayer to the Holy Spirit (p. 4) · ■ Our Father (p. 4)]

■ Word of God

"Joseph her husband, being a just man..."

— Matthew 1:19

■ Meditation

The Gospel tells us almost nothing about Joseph — and it is precisely in this that he speaks to us most deeply. One single word suffices to define him: just. Not merely in a legal sense, but in the biblical sense — a man whose heart is attuned to the heart of God.

Joseph did not wait for great occasions to be holy. He was holy in the workshop of Nazareth, in the silence of his home, in the repeated gestures of work, in faithful obedience to what God asked of him day after day, without witnesses, without applause.

The holiness to which God calls us resembles his: humble, hidden, persevering. It is built in faithfulness to small things, where no one watches but God. Today, let Joseph take you by the hand on this path of ordinary holiness.

■ Intercession prayers

1. For ourselves

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, a just man, grant us the grace to sincerely desire holiness. Not the holiness of great things, but that of daily faithfulness — in our words, our acts, our most hidden thoughts. May our life, even ordinary, be an offering pleasing to your eyes. Amen.

2. For sinners and those far from God

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, stretch forth your merciful hand to all who have lost the path of justice and righteousness. May no soul believe itself too far from you to return. Remind every hardened heart that your grace can transform everything. Amen.

3. For leaders and those in authority

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, model of men in responsibility, grant to all who govern or exercise authority over others the grace to do so in justice, integrity and service of the common good. Amen.

4. For those suffering injustice

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, defender of the weak, be the help of all those who are victims of injustice — those whose rights are trampled, those who are crushed, those whose voice is never heard. Be their justice when men deny it to them. Amen.

✍ My personal intention

(Freely formulate your personal prayer here, in relation to the theme of the day)

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❄ *Silence — Place your intention in the heart of Saint Joseph* ❄

[Closing: ■ Hail Mary (p. 4) · ■ Hail Joseph (p. 5) · ■ Glory Be (p. 5) · ■ Hymn to the Holy Spirit (p. 5) · ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 5)]

DAY II · JOSEPH, SPOUSE OF MARY

Purity of heart and protective love

[Opening: ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 4) · ■ Prayer to the Holy Spirit (p. 4) · ■ Our Father (p. 4)]

■ Word of God

"Joseph did as the angel of the Lord commanded him and took her as his wife."

— Matthew 1:24

■ Meditation

Joseph loved Mary with a love unique in the world — a love so pure it resembled light: transparent, selfless, protective. He did not seek to possess, but to give. He did not seek to satisfy himself, but to serve.

When the mystery of the Incarnation was revealed to him, Joseph could have withdrawn, feeling excluded from God's plan. Instead, he chose to enter fully into this mystery, offering his entire life as a protective veil over Mary and the Child to come.

To love in the manner of Joseph means choosing the good of the other before one's own comfort. It means protecting without smothering, giving without counting, remaining faithful without conditions.

■ Intercession prayers

1. For married couples

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, chaste and loving spouse, protect all married couples. Grant them the grace of a love that grows, forgives and endures in trials. May each spouse seek the good of the other before their own, at Joseph's school. Amen.

2. For couples in crisis

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, grant your light and peace to couples going through a crisis or deep wound. Where human love has grown cold, warm it with your divine fire. Where trust is broken, lay your healing hand. Amen.

3. For those who wish to start a family

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, strengthen the hope of all those who wish to start a family and wait in faith. Keep their hearts pure in the waiting. May your will be their peace. Amen.

4. For purity of heart

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, a man of pure heart, free all those who struggle against the temptations of impurity. Grant them the grace of a renewed vision and a dignity recovered in your mercy. Amen.

✍ My personal intention

(Freely formulate your personal prayer here, in relation to the theme of the day)

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❄ *Silence — Place your intention in the heart of Saint Joseph* ❄

[Closing: ■ Hail Mary (p. 4) · ■ Hail Joseph (p. 5) · ■ Glory Be (p. 5) · ■ Hymn to the Holy Spirit (p. 5) · ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 5)]

DAY III · JOSEPH, FATHER OF JESUS

Spiritual fatherhood and self-giving

[Opening: ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 4) · ■ Prayer to the Holy Spirit (p. 4) · ■ Our Father (p. 4)]

■ Word of God

"He gave him the name Jesus."

— Matthew 1:25

■ Meditation

To give one's name to a child is to receive him as one's own. In giving to Mary's Child the name the angel had prescribed, Joseph accomplished the most decisive gesture of his fatherhood: he acknowledged that child, adopted him, committed himself to him without return.

This fatherhood is both adoptive and profoundly real. The Gospel tells us that Jesus was subject to them — to Mary and to Joseph. The Son of God wanted a father on earth, and he chose to obey him. What incomparable dignity for this man of Nazareth!

Joseph teaches us that true fatherhood is not a matter of blood, but of presence, gift and faithfulness. It can also be exercised spiritually: in accompanying those God entrusts to us, in prayer for others, in discreet service of the weakest.

■ Intercession prayers

1. For fathers of families

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, foster father of the Son of God, grant all fathers the grace to exercise their fatherhood with love, wisdom and courage. May they be for their children a reflection of your own paternal tenderness. Amen.

2. For mothers

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph who surrounded Mary with such care and respect, honour all the mothers of the world. Sustain those who carry the weight of motherhood alone, strengthen those who are exhausted, reward their silent gift. Amen.

3. For children without a father or family

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, be the father of all children who have none. Take under your protection orphans and the abandoned. Send them paternal and maternal hearts to welcome them. Amen.

4. For those who spiritually accompany others

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Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph who exercised spiritual fatherhood over the Saviour himself, grant wisdom and gentleness to all who accompany others on the path of faith — priests, catechists, parents and spiritual directors. Amen.

✍ My personal intention

(Freely formulate your personal prayer here, in relation to the theme of the day)

❄ Silence — Place your intention in the heart of Saint Joseph ❄

[Closing: ■ Hail Mary (p. 4) · ■ Hail Joseph (p. 5) · ■ Glory Be (p. 5) · ■ Hymn to the Holy Spirit (p. 5) · ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 5)]

DAY IV · JOSEPH, MAN OF SILENCE

Listening to God in the night

[Opening: ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 4) · ■ Prayer to the Holy Spirit (p. 4) · ■ Our Father (p. 4)]

■ Word of God

"Behold, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream."

— Matthew 1:20

■ Meditation

The Gospel reports not a single word spoken by Joseph. Not one phrase, not even a whisper. And yet, what man hears better than he! God speaks to him in the silence of dreams, and Joseph listens. God asks him to rise — and Joseph rises, without discussion, without delay.

Joseph's silence is not absence. It is total presence, a heart open like a blank page upon which God can write what he wishes. In this world saturated with noise and distraction, his example is an urgent invitation: learn to be silent in order to begin to hear.

All of Joseph's great decisions — remaining with Mary, fleeing to Egypt, returning to Nazareth — were made in the night, in recollection, in trustful abandonment to God. Discernment is born in silence.

■ Intercession prayers

1. For the gift of discernment

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, man of silence and listening, grant us the grace to discern your voice amid the noise of the world. Teach us to silence our own desires in order to hear what you truly want from us. Amen.

2. For those passing through interior darkness

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph who received your messages in the darkness of night, be close to all those passing through an interior night and who no longer perceive your presence. Remind them that you are there, even when you are silent. Amen.

3. For contemplatives and souls of prayer

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, model of silent souls, bless all those who have consecrated their life to prayer — monks, nuns, hermits and contemplatives. May their hidden intercession be a rampart for the Church. Amen.

4. For those in discernment or conversion

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, grant your grace to all souls at a crossroads in their spiritual life — on retreat, discerning a vocation, or on the threshold of a conversion. May silence become for them the place of your encounter. Amen.

✍ My personal intention

(Freely formulate your personal prayer here, in relation to the theme of the day)

❄ Silence — Place your intention in the heart of Saint Joseph ❄

[Closing: ■ Hail Mary (p. 4) · ■ Hail Joseph (p. 5) · ■ Glory Be (p. 5) · ■ Hymn to the Holy Spirit (p. 5) · ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 5)]

DAY V · JOSEPH, CRAFTSMAN OF NAZARETH

Sanctified work, offering to the Father

[Opening: ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 4) · ■ Prayer to the Holy Spirit (p. 4) · ■ Our Father (p. 4)]

■ Word of God

"Is not this the carpenter's son?"

— Matthew 13:55

■ Meditation

The Son of God chose to grow up in a craftsman's workshop. He learned to hold a tool, to shape wood, to work with his hands — at Joseph's school. This choice is no accident: God sanctifies human work by inhabiting it from within.

Joseph did not work to enrich himself or to make a name for himself. He worked to feed the Child-God and his Mother. Every stroke of the plane, every piece of wood assembled was a silent prayer, a concrete offering, an act of love.

Our daily tasks — professional, family, even the most thankless — can become acts of worship if we live them in this spirit of offering. Today, entrust to Joseph your material needs and all those who toil or seek work.

■ Intercession prayers

1. For the sanctification of work

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, craftsman of Nazareth, teach us to sanctify our daily work. May every task accomplished with care and honesty become for us a prayer and a service of your glory. Amen.

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2. For workers in difficulty

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, come to the aid of all those who work in difficult, unjust or dangerous conditions. Protect them and defend their rights. Amen.

3. For the unemployed

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, patron of workers, sustain and console all those who are without work and live in anguish about tomorrow. Open for them doors that no man can close, and may their dignity never be crushed by discouragement. Amen.

4. For craftsmen, entrepreneurs and creators

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, craftsman with skilled hands, bless all those who create, build and innovate. May their talent be placed at the service of the good and may they never lose sight of the fact that every gift comes from you. Amen.

✍ My personal intention

(Freely formulate your personal prayer here, in relation to the theme of the day)

❄ Silence — Place your intention in the heart of Saint Joseph ❄

[Closing: ■ Hail Mary (p. 4) · ■ Hail Joseph (p. 5) · ■ Glory Be (p. 5) · ■ Hymn to the Holy Spirit (p. 5) · ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 5)]

DAY VI · JOSEPH'S FLIGHT INTO EGYPT

Trust in trial and exile

[Opening: ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 4) · ■ Prayer to the Holy Spirit (p. 4) · ■ Our Father (p. 4)]

■ Word of God

"Rise, take the child and his mother, and flee to Egypt, and remain there until I tell you."

— Matthew 2:13

■ Meditation

In the middle of the night, Joseph receives the order to leave everything. No sufficient preparation, no complete explanation, no guarantee about the future. Just a voice in the silence, a command, and trust to be lived in total darkness.

Joseph rises. He takes the Child and his Mother. He departs. This immediate obedience in the night is one of the most striking images of faith in all of Scripture. Joseph does not understand everything — but he trusts in the One who understands everything.

How many of us are living our own flight into Egypt: a sudden trial, a brutal loss, an interior exile? Egypt was not the final destination — it was a passage. All our trials are too. God's hand never lets go on the way.

■ Intercession prayers

1. For those crossing a sudden trial

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Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph who rose in the night without fully understanding, grant to all those whom life strikes abruptly the grace not to despair. May their faith hold in the darkness. Amen.

2. For refugees, exiles and migrants

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, refugee in Egypt with Mary and the Child, be the refuge of all those who have had to flee their land. Protect them, grant them dignity and welcome, and hasten the day of their return. Amen.

3. For the sick and those suffering in body

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph who knew the weariness of the road, be the strength of all the sick. Grant them peace in suffering and, if it is your will, healing of their body. Amen.

4. For trust in moments of incomprehension

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, grant us the grace to trust you even when we do not understand what you allow. Remind our hearts that you write straight on crooked lines, and that Egypt is never the last word. Amen.

✍ My personal intention

(Freely formulate your personal prayer here, in relation to the theme of the day)

❄ Silence — Place your intention in the heart of Saint Joseph ❄

[Closing: ■ Hail Mary (p. 4) · ■ Hail Joseph (p. 5) · ■ Glory Be (p. 5) · ■ Hymn to the Holy Spirit (p. 5) · ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 5)]

DAY VII · JOSEPH, PATRON OF FAMILIES

The protection of the home, children and loved ones

[Opening: ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 4) · ■ Prayer to the Holy Spirit (p. 4) · ■ Our Father (p. 4)]

■ Word of God

"He rose and took the child and his mother, and went into the land of Israel."

— Matthew 2:21

■ Meditation

The Holy Family of Nazareth is the holy family par excellence — not because it was without difficulty, but because it passed through all its difficulties in love, faith and unity. And it is Joseph who was its watchful guardian and solid support.

His primary mission was to protect. To protect Mary, to protect the Child, to protect the home against every threat. This mission he fulfilled with absolute faithfulness, at the cost of his comfort, his security, sometimes his reputation.

Every family needs this protective figure — someone who watches, who prays, who holds firm when storms arrive. Joseph is the tireless patron of every hearth. He intercedes with particular tenderness for the most

wounded and abandoned families.

■ Intercession prayers

1. For the protection of homes

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, guardian of the Holy Family, extend your protection over all the families of the world. Drive far from every home hatred, violence and indifference. May your peace reign where discord and wounds hold sway. Amen.

2. For broken families and suffering children

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, grant your consolation to families separated by divorce, death or conflict. Protect particularly the children who bear the wounds of family breakdown. Amen.

3. For parents raising children alone

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, sustain all those who carry the weight of the family alone. May they never feel abandoned, and be yourself their strength in moments when they can no longer go on. Amen.

4. For the family of the Church

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, watch over this great family you founded in your blood. May its members love one another as you have loved us, overcome their divisions, and witness to the world the beauty of your communion. Amen.

✍ My personal intention

(Freely formulate your personal prayer here, in relation to the theme of the day)

❄ Silence — Place your intention in the heart of Saint Joseph ❄

[Closing: ■ Hail Mary (p. 4) · ■ Hail Joseph (p. 5) · ■ Glory Be (p. 5) · ■ Hymn to the Holy Spirit (p. 5) · ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 5)]

DAY VIII · JOSEPH, PATRON OF THE DYING

The grace of a good death and peace of soul

[Opening: ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 4) · ■ Prayer to the Holy Spirit (p. 4) · ■ Our Father (p. 4)]

■ Word of God

"In peace I will both lie down and sleep; for you alone, O Lord, make me dwell in safety."

— Psalm 4:9

■ Meditation

Church tradition teaches that Joseph died surrounded by Jesus and Mary. What a blessed death! He closed his eyes in the arms of the Mother of God and the Son of God himself. That is why the Church invokes him as the protector of the dying.

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Death is the most solitary passage of our human existence. No one can make it for us. And yet we are not alone: Joseph is there, he who made this passage in the presence of the living Christ. He knows how to hold the hand of those who enter the night of the last journey.

Pray today for all those who are dying. Pray for yourself — for the grace of a peaceful death, entrusted into the loving hands of the Father.

■ Intercession prayers

1. For those dying at this very moment

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph who breathed his last in your hands and those of Mary, assist at this very moment all those who are at the hour of their passing. May your mercy welcome them in peace. Amen.

2. For our deceased

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, grant the light and eternal peace to all those who have left us. Receive them in the joy of your house, where tears are wiped away forever. Amen.

3. For those who fear death

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, drive the fear of death from the hearts of those it paralyses. Remind them that you have conquered death and that at the end of the passage it is your face that awaits them. Amen.

4. For the grace of a good death for ourselves

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, grant us the grace to live in such a way that our death will be a death of the just — reconciled, at peace, entrusted to your hands like a child falling asleep in the arms of its father. Amen.

✍ My personal intention

(Freely formulate your personal prayer here, in relation to the theme of the day)

❄ Silence — Place your intention in the heart of Saint Joseph ❄

[Closing: ■ Hail Mary (p. 4) · ■ Hail Joseph (p. 5) · ■ Glory Be (p. 5) · ■ Hymn to the Holy Spirit (p. 5) · ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 5)]

DAY IX · JOSEPH, PATRON OF THE UNIVERSAL CHURCH

Total surrender — conclusion of the novena

[Opening: ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 4) · ■ Prayer to the Holy Spirit (p. 4) · ■ Our Father (p. 4)]

■ Word of God

"He made him lord of his house and ruler of all his possessions."

— Psalm 105:21 — applied to Saint Joseph

■ Meditation

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Here we are at the end of these nine days of prayer. You have walked with Joseph — his justice, his love for Mary, his fatherhood, his silence, his work, his courage in trial, his protection of families, his assistance to the dying. You have contemplated a whole man, a holy man, a man to whom God gave a trust without equal.

Pope Pius IX proclaimed Joseph patron of the Universal Church. His prayer embraces the entire family of God — its pastors, its faithful, its missions, its persecuted communities. Just as he protected the Holy Family of Nazareth, he protects the great family of Christ throughout the world.

On this last day, entrust to his hands everything you have carried during this novena — what you have been able to put into words and what you carry too deeply for words. Joseph knows how to intercede beyond words.

■ Intercession prayers

1. For the Holy Father and the pastors of the Church

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, patron of the Universal Church, keep the Pope, the bishops and all priests in faithfulness, holiness and courage. May they be true shepherds after your own heart. Amen.

2. For missionaries and evangelisers

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, grant strength and fruitfulness to all those who carry your Gospel to the ends of the earth. Where faith is persecuted, give the courage of martyrs. Where it has been extinguished, rekindle it. Amen.

3. For priestly and religious vocations

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph who responded without hesitation to God's call, touch the hearts of many young people and call them to follow you in the priesthood and consecrated life. Amen.

4. For the offering of all the intentions of the novena

Lord Jesus, through the intercession of Saint Joseph, receive all the prayers and intentions carried during these nine days. What we have been able to formulate and what we have not been able to say — take all of it. Grant us according to your wisdom what our souls need most. May your will be done. Amen.

✍ My personal intention

(Freely formulate your personal prayer here, in relation to the theme of the day)

❄ Silence — Place your intention in the heart of Saint Joseph ❄

[Closing: ■ Hail Mary (p. 4) · ■ Hail Joseph (p. 5) · ■ Glory Be (p. 5) · ■ Hymn to the Holy Spirit (p. 5) · ✝ Sign of the Cross (p. 5)]

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ACT OF CONSECRATION TO SAINT JOSEPH

To be recited at the end of the novena

O glorious Saint Joseph, I choose you today as father, protector and guide of my soul. I entrust myself entirely to your powerful intercession.

You who were chosen by the eternal Father to watch over his beloved Son, watch also over me, poor child of the Church. You who kept Mary in purity and love, keep my heart pure from all sin, from all lukewarmness, from all infidelity.

I entrust to you what I have carried during these nine days: my joys, my sorrows, my most secret intentions, the people dear to me, the situations I cannot control. Take all. Present all to Jesus, who can refuse you nothing, he who called you father on earth.

Saint Joseph, I consecrate myself to you this day. Be my father in faith, my guide in uncertainty, my support in weakness, my intercessor at the hour of death. And lead me, through Mary your holy spouse, to Jesus — the Way, the Truth and the Life. Amen.

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LITANY OF SAINT JOSEPH

Lord, have mercy. — Lord, have mercy.
Christ, have mercy. — Christ, have mercy.
Lord, have mercy. — Lord, have mercy.
Christ, hear us. — Christ, graciously hear us.

God the Father of heaven, — have mercy on us.
God the Son, Redeemer of the world, — have mercy on us.
God the Holy Spirit, — have mercy on us.
Holy Trinity, one God, — have mercy on us.

Holy Mary, Mother of God, — pray for us.

Saint Joseph, — pray for us.
Noble son of the house of David, — pray for us.
Light of patriarchs, — pray for us.
Spouse of the Mother of God, — pray for us.
Chaste guardian of the Virgin Mary, — pray for us.
Witness of the mystery of the Incarnation, — pray for us.

Foster father of the Son of God, — pray for us.
Loving father who held God in your arms, — pray for us.
Father who taught Jesus the work of his hands, — pray for us.
Head and guardian of the Holy Family, — pray for us.

Joseph most just, — pray for us.
Joseph most chaste, — pray for us.
Joseph most prudent, — pray for us.
Joseph most valiant, — pray for us.
Joseph most obedient, — pray for us.
Joseph most faithful, — pray for us.
Joseph most humble, — pray for us.
Joseph most patient, — pray for us.

Man of silence and prayer, — pray for us.
Man whose faith never wavered in trial, — pray for us.

Admirable model of all workers, — pray for us.
Craftsman who sanctified the work of hands, — pray for us.
Patron of those who toil and seek work, — pray for us.

Glory of family life, — pray for us.
Support and refuge of families in peril, — pray for us.
Guardian of virgins and consecrated souls, — pray for us.
Father of orphans and the abandoned, — pray for us.
Consolation of afflicted hearts, — pray for us.
Refuge of the poor and the humble, — pray for us.

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Hope of the sick and suffering, — pray for us.
Support of the dying at the hour of their passing, — pray for us.
Intercessor for the souls in purgatory, — pray for us.

Guardian of the Church in her trials, — pray for us.
Terror of demons, — pray for us.
Protector of the Holy Universal Church, — pray for us.
Patron of missionaries and evangelisers, — pray for us.

Lamb of God, who takest away the sins of the world, — spare us, O Lord.
Lamb of God, who takest away the sins of the world, — graciously hear us, O Lord.
Lamb of God, who takest away the sins of the world, — have mercy on us.

He made him lord of his house, and ruler of all his possessions.

Let us pray.

O God, who in your wondrous Providence did choose Saint Joseph to be the husband of your most holy Mother and the guardian of your beloved Son, grant us, through his intercession, the grace to bear in ourselves something of his justice, his silence and his faith. Make of us souls open to your will, faithful in trials, and trusting unto the hour of our death. Through Jesus Christ our Lord, who lives and reigns with you in the unity of the Holy Spirit, for ever and ever. Amen.